

SLEEP, BABY. PLEASE.

Bedtime Routine Builder Pad

*Stick it on the nursery door.
Your 2am brain will thank you.*

TONIGHT'S PAD

Baby's Name:

Date:

Baby's Age:

Awake Window:

AWAKE WINDOW QUICK REFERENCE

AGE	AWAKE	NAPS	BEDTIME
0–6 wks	45–60 min	4–5/day	Variable
6–12 wks	60–90 min	4/day	8–9 pm
3–4 mo	90 min	3–4/day	7:30–8:30 pm
4–6 mo	2 hrs	3/day	7–8 pm
6–8 mo	2.5 hrs	3–3.5/day	7–8 pm
8–12 mo	3–3.5 hrs	2/day	6:30–7:30 pm
12–18 mo	4–5 hrs	1–2/day	7–7:30 pm
18–24 mo	5–6 hrs	1/day	7–7:30 pm

TONIGHT'S RESPONSE METHOD

Decide before night falls — your 2pm brain makes better decisions than your 2am brain.

- ☐ Ferber ☐ Chair ☐ Fading
☐ CIO ☐ Pick Up/Put Down ☐ Our Own Plan

Cover & Setup

Tonight's Routine

Night Log

Safe Sleep

Notes



Tonight's Routine

Check off each step in order · Add your own timing · Note what worked

Baby:

Date:

Bedtime target

Actual in-cri

1

☐

Transition signal given

e.g. 'lights are going dim, sleep time soon'

Time:

2

☐

Screens & stimulation off

TV, tablets, bright lights — all off

Time:

3

☐

Bath or warm wipe-down

Warm water relaxes the nervous system

Time:

4

☐

Lotion massage

Optional but calming — lavender works beautifully

Time:

5

☐

Pyjamas & sleep sack on

Check tog rating for room temperature

Time:

6

☐

Feed given (not to sleep)

Dim, quiet room — drowsy is the goal, not asleep

Time:

7

☐

1–3 books or songs

Rocking chair / glider; keep it soft and slow

Time:

8

☐

Final goodnight phrase said

Same words every night — baby learns the cue

Time:

9

☐

White noise turned on

Continuous, low level — not inside the crib

Time:

10

☐

Room fully dark

Blackout curtains + cover monitor LEDs

Time:

11

☐

Baby placed in crib DROWSY but AWAKE

The single most important skill in this book

Time:

12

☐

Parent exits calmly & consistently

Same every night — consistency is the magic

Time:

YOUR CUSTOM ROUTINE SEQUENCE

MY ROUTINE ORDER TONIGHT

Write your steps in the exact order you do them. Same sequence every night.

1

2

3

4

5

6

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Night Waking Log

Track every wake · Spot patterns · Celebrate the wins

Baby:

Night of:

Sleep method:

#	Wake time	Duration awake	How resolved	Resettled by	Notes
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					

OVERNIGHT SUMMARY

Total wake count:

Longest sleep stretch:

Total sleep time:

Wake-up time:

TONIGHT OVERALL:

NOTES & OBSERVATIONS:

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Safe Sleep Checklist

AAP-aligned guidelines · Run through this every night · Non-negotiable

■ If you have concerns about your baby's sleep or breathing, always contact your paediatrician first.

THE SLEEP SURFACE

- ☐ Firm, flat mattress · no incline, pillow-top, or wedge
- ☐ Fitted sheet only — no loose blankets, bumpers, or pillows
- ☐ No stuffed animals, positioners, or sleep aids inside crib
- ☐ Sleep sack used in place of blanket — correct tog for temp
- ☐ Baby placed on back · every sleep · every time · no exceptions
- ☐ Crib / bassinet / play yard ONLY (not swing, car seat, bouncer)

THE ROOM

- ☐ Room temp confirmed between 68–72°F / 20–22°C
- ☐ Baby's chest warm but not sweaty — adjust tog if needed
- ☐ True blackout achieved — if you can see your hand, too bright
- ☐ White noise running at low continuous level — not in crib
- ☐ Monitor LEDs covered with electrical tape
- ☐ No nightlight in use (or red-spectrum light only)

BEFORE YOU LEAVE THE ROOM

- ☐ Transition signal completed? (e.g. goodnight phrase said)
- ☐ Baby is drowsy but awake — NOT already asleep
- ☐ Door cracked / monitor positioned and working
- ☐ You've decided how you'll respond to first cry

◆ YOUR SLEEP PROMISE ◆

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Notes & Patterns

Get it out of your head · spot what's working · celebrate every win

BRAIN DUMP

Everything on your mind — no filter

PATTERNS I NOTICE

QUESTIONS FOR PAEDIATRICIAN

WIN LOG

Every win counts — big AND small

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

MY MANTRA FOR TONIGHT

(write it. say it before you go in.)

THIS WEEK'S SLEEP GOAL

FREE NOTES

"Done is better than perfect. Pick one thing and do it tonight." — Six & Thriving

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